

# FILM DOSSIER: IRON MAN

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Phase 1 · Film #1 · The film that starts everything

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                             |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | 1 of 29 (Infinity Saga)                                                                                           |
| Phase                  | Phase 1 (2008–2012)                                                                                               |
| Real title             | <i>IRON MAN</i>                                                                                                   |
| Decoy / codename title | " <i>DESERT ROSE</i> " on call sheets, permits and the Lone Pine and Long Island location signage                 |
| Release date           | <b>Friday, May 2, 2008</b>                                                                                        |
| Distributor            | Paramount Pictures                                                                                                |
| Director               | Jon Favreau                                                                                                       |
| Writers                | Mark Fergus & Hawk Ostby, Art Marcum & Matt Holloway                                                              |
| Rating / runtime       | <b>PG-13</b> (sequences of intense sci-fi action and violence, and brief suggestive content) · <b>148 minutes</b> |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>techno-thriller</b> / <b>military-industrial drama</b>                            |
| Budget                 | \$140 million                                                                                                     |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                       |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK.</b> The Iron Man franchise is his. |
| Top-billed cast                 | see below                                                   |

| Character                                                              | Actor                                                                              | Born             | Age at release<br>(May 2, 2008) |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>Tony Stark / Iron Man</b>                                           | <b>Marc-Anthony Bullock</b>                                                        | Jan 5,<br>1982   | 26                              |
| <b>Virginia "Pepper" Potts</b>                                         | <b>Tayia Boyd</b>                                                                  | Feb 3,<br>1982   | 26                              |
| <b>Lt. Col. James "Rhodey" Rhodes</b>                                  | Don Cheadle                                                                        | Nov 29,<br>1964  | 43                              |
| <b>Obadiah Stane / Iron Monger</b>                                     | Jeff Bridges                                                                       | Dec 4,<br>1949   | 58                              |
| <b>Harold "Happy" Hogan</b>                                            | Jon Favreau                                                                        | Oct 19,<br>1966  | 41                              |
| <b>Professor Ho Yinsen</b>                                             | Shaun Toub                                                                         | Dec 15,<br>1963  | 44                              |
| <b>Wong-Chu</b>                                                        | Tzi Ma                                                                             | June 10,<br>1962 | 45                              |
| <b>Agent Jasper Sitwell (S.H.I.E.L.D.)</b>                             | Maximiliano Hernández                                                              | Nov 12,<br>1973  | 34                              |
| <b>Nick Fury</b> ( <i>post-credit</i> )                                | Samuel L. Jackson                                                                  | Dec 21,<br>1948  | 59                              |
| <b>Janet van Dyne</b> ( <i>cameo</i> )                                 | <b>Elxa Bullock</b> ( <i>secret cameo, uncredited until Comic-Con, July 2008</i> ) | Aug 29,<br>1980  | 27                              |
| <b>Mistress Death</b> ( <i>uncredited; silent at Yinsen's death</i> )  | Aubrey Plaza                                                                       | June 26,<br>1984 | 23                              |
| <b>Stan Lee</b> ( <i>cameo, mistaken for Hugh Hefner at the gala</i> ) | Stan Lee                                                                           | Dec 28,<br>1922  | 85                              |

*Casting note: Wong-Chu has never been played by a real-life actor, so this is an original casting of a real actor. Everyone else follows the Casting Rules.*

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### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | <i>Tales of Suspense</i> #39 (March 1963): the origin, by Stan Lee, Larry Lieber, Don Heck & Jack Kirby. <i>Iron Man</i> #163–200 (1982–1985): Obadiah Stane's war on Tony Stark, ending in the Iron Monger battle, by Denny O'Neil & Luke McDonnell.                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Supporting comics        | <i>Tales of Suspense</i> #40 (1963, the gold armor) · #45 (1963, first Pepper Potts & Happy Hogan) · #48 (1963, the first red-and-gold armor, Steve Ditko) · <i>Iron Man</i> #118 (1979, first Jim Rhodes) · <i>Iron Man</i> #144 (1981, how Rhodey met Tony in the war zone) · <i>Iron Man</i> vol. 3 #55 (2002, Tony publicly reveals he's Iron Man) · <i>Iron Man: Extremis</i> (2005–06, Warren Ellis & Adi Granov, the modern origin moved to Afghanistan) |
| 616 accuracy notes       | See Section 3A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Nerf check               | ✓ Every armor, hero and villain appears at the power level the comics give that specific armor model. See the powers table.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

#### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | <b>96%</b> . The origin, armor progression, supporting cast, villains and the Stane arc all come straight from 616. The only changes are sliding-timescale updates and compressing a three-year comic arc into one film. |

##### Straight from the page:

- **The origin:** Tony, a weapons-industry genius, is wounded by a booby trap with **shrapnel lodged near his heart**. He's captured by the warlord **Wong-Chu** and forced to build weapons, and with the Nobel-nominated physicist **Ho Yinsen** he builds the **Mark I** instead. **Yinsen sacrifices himself** to buy Tony time.
- **The chest plate:** the armor's **chest plate is what keeps Tony's heart beating**. It has to be **recharged**, and yes, **Tony plugs himself into a wall socket** in one scene, straight out of the Silver Age.
- **The armor progression, exactly as in the comics:** **gray Mark I** (*ToS* #39) → **gold Mark II** (*ToS* #40, "the Golden Avenger") → **red-and-gold Mark III** (*ToS* #48).
- **Rhodey** is a **Marine Corps aviator** (as in 616) who picks Tony up after the escape (*Iron Man* #144).
- **Happy Hogan** is a **former boxer** turned Tony's driver and bodyguard (*ToS* #45).
- **Pepper Potts** is Tony's sharp, capable executive assistant (*ToS* #45).
- **Obadiah Stane** is bald and **obsessed with chess**. He talks about people as pawns, targets Tony through his company, and builds the **Iron Monger** armor from Tony's stolen designs (*Iron Man* #163–200). **He dies by his own hand after he's beaten** (*Iron Man* #200), handled off-screen for PG-13.
- **The "bodyguard" cover story:** Tony first tells the press that Iron Man is his **bodyguard**, the classic 616 secret-identity ruse. Then, following the modern 616 reveal (vol. 3 #55), he tells the world: **"I am Iron Man."**
- **The Maria Stark Foundation**, named for Tony's late mother and the Avengers' future funder in 616, holds its

charity gala.

- **Tony's home is 890 Fifth Avenue, Manhattan**, the Stark family mansion that becomes **Avengers Mansion** in 616.

- **Stark Industries headquarters is on Long Island, New York**, as in 616.

- **Howard and Maria Stark died in a car crash** (616), which put Tony in charge of the company at 21.

### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| Vietnam → **Afghanistan** | The sliding timescale. Marvel's own *Extremis* (2005) moved the origin to Afghanistan, and we follow the latest 616 version. |

| The Stane arc (1982–85) is compressed into one film | Runtime. The beats (takeover, chess games, stolen armor tech, Iron Monger, suicide) stay the same, but Tony's slide back into alcoholism is **saved for *Iron Man 2*** so it gets the time it needs. |

| Mark I built in a **cave** instead of a jungle hut | Follows the Afghanistan update. |

| Mark I gets an improvised flamethrower and a short rocket hop | Derived from later 616 armor tech so the escape is believable. It's listed here to be transparent. |

| Tony's in-universe age is **26** (b. May 29, 1981) | This matches Marc-Anthony. 616 Tony's age slides; ours follows the actor per the real-time rule. |

| Casting of Pepper, Happy, Yinsen and others | Follows the Casting Rules. The characters' histories and personalities are unchanged. |

### POWERS & ABILITIES: CHARACTER BY CHARACTER

| Character                        | 616 powers & abilities (source)                                                                                                                                       | Shown in this film                                                                                                                                 | Held back (and why)                                                                                             | Power-level match                                             |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tony Stark</b> (unarmored)    | Super-genius inventor and engineer; expert businessman; skilled hand-to-hand fighter (trained by Happy/Cap in later issues) ( <i>ToS</i> #39 on)                      | Builds a working armor from scraps in a cave. Designs the Mk II and Mk III. Out-thinks Stane in business and in combat.                            | Hand-to-hand training (it comes later in the comics too)                                                        | ✓ 100%                                                        |
| <b>Mark I (gray)</b>             | Transistor-boosted <b>superhuman strength</b> ; heavy steel plating that stops small-arms fire; reverse-magnetism effects ( <i>ToS</i> #39)                           | Tears through a steel cave door; bullets bounce off; flings Wong-Chu's men across the cave                                                         | Sustained flight (Mk I couldn't fly on 616 either)                                                              | ✓ 100%                                                        |
| <b>Mark II (gold)</b>            | Lighter gold armor; <b>jet boot flight</b> ; boosted strength ( <i>ToS</i> #40)                                                                                       | First real flight, the famous "clean slate" test over Long Island Sound                                                                            | Advanced weapons (added in later models)                                                                        | ✓ 100%                                                        |
| <b>Mark III (red &amp; gold)</b> | Sleeker armor; <b>repulsor rays</b> in the palms; <b>uni-beam</b> in the chest; supersonic flight; <b>multi-ton strength</b> ; sensors and radar ( <i>ToS</i> #48 on) | Repulsors, uni-beam, supersonic flight, lifting a car full of civilians clear of a collapsing overpass, blocking tank rounds                       | The later 100-ton-class models and Extremis (these come as the armors advance in later films, as in the comics) | ✓ 100% for this model                                         |
| <b>Iron Monger</b> (Stane)       | Massive armor built from stolen Stark tech. <b>Stronger and more heavily armored than Tony's current suit</b> , with a heavy arsenal ( <i>Iron Man</i> #200)          | Outmuscles the Mark III. Tony wins <b>by out-thinking him</b> by cutting his power and using his size against him, not by suddenly being stronger. | –                                                                                                               | ✓ 100% (Stane loses on strategy, not because he was weakened) |
| <b>Obadiah Stane</b> (unarmored) | Master manipulator and chess strategist; ruthless businessman ( <i>Iron Man</i> #163)                                                                                 | The hostile takeover of Stark Industries; the arms deals with Wong-Chu                                                                             | –                                                                                                               | ✓ 100%                                                        |
| <b>Wong-Chu</b>                  | Ruthless warlord; skilled military commander ( <i>ToS</i> #39)                                                                                                        | Captures and tortures Tony, commands an army                                                                                                       | –                                                                                                               | ✓ 100%                                                        |
| <b>Ho Yinsen</b>                 | Nobel-nominated physicist and engineer ( <i>ToS</i> #39)                                                                                                              | Co-builds the Mk I and the chest plate                                                                                                             | –                                                                                                               | ✓ 100%                                                        |
| <b>James Rhodes</b>              | Elite Marine combat pilot; skilled soldier ( <i>Iron Man</i> #118)                                                                                                    | Pilots the rescue helicopter; flies combat support during the finale                                                                               | <b>Wearing the armor himself</b> ( <i>Iron Man</i> #169, 1983). Saved                                           | ✓ 100%                                                        |

| Character           | 616 powers & abilities (source)                                                               | Shown in this film                                                            | Held back (and why)                                                       | Power-level match |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
|                     |                                                                                               |                                                                               | for <i>Iron Man 2</i> to line up with the drinking arc, as in the comics. |                   |
| <b>Happy Hogan</b>  | Former professional boxer (ToS #45)                                                           | Knocks out two of Stane's security guards                                     | –                                                                         | ✓ 100%            |
| <b>Pepper Potts</b> | Brilliant executive; resourceful and courageous (ToS #45)                                     | Runs Stark Industries while Tony's captive; steals the evidence against Stane | <b>Rescue armor</b> (616, much later). It's her future, not a nerf.       | ✓ 100%            |
| <b>Nick Fury</b>    | Infinity Formula (slowed aging); master spy and strategist; WWII veteran (Sgt. Fury #1, 1963) | Walks through Tony's security like it isn't there                             | Full history (shown in Captain America's film)                            | ✓ 100%            |

## 4. STORY

| Field          | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Logline</b> | A weapons-industry genius is captured by the warlord using his own weapons. He builds a suit of armor to escape, and comes home determined to fix what he helped break, unaware that the most dangerous man in his life is sitting across the chessboard. |
| <b>Theme</b>   | <b>Responsibility.</b> Tony built weapons without caring where they ended up. Iron Man is how he makes up for it.                                                                                                                                         |

### What the movie is about

#### ACT ONE: THE CAVE

- **Kunar Province, Afghanistan.** **Tony Stark** (26), the playboy genius who has run **Stark Industries** since his parents died, is demonstrating a new transistor-guided weapons system for U.S. forces.
- His convoy is ambushed. A booby-trapped Stark shell explodes and **shrapnel lodges near his heart**.
- He wakes up in a cave, prisoner of the warlord **Wong-Chu**. Wong-Chu's men are carrying **Stark weapons**. Somebody sold them.
- **Ho Yinsen**, a Nobel-nominated physicist and fellow prisoner, has kept Tony alive with a **chest plate** that keeps the shrapnel from reaching his heart.
- Wong-Chu orders them to build him a weapon. Instead, they build the **Mark I**.
- The escape. **Yinsen sacrifices himself** to buy Tony time. As he dies, only the audience sees **a pale woman in a dark hooded cloak** standing silently at the cave mouth. Then she's gone.

- Tony tears through the cave and burns the stockpile of Stark weapons. Wong-Chu escapes.
- **Marine aviator James Rhodes** picks him up in the desert, and a friendship begins.

## ACT TWO: THE GOLDEN AVENGER

- Back in New York, Tony announces that **Stark Industries will stop making weapons**. The stock collapses.
- **Obadiah Stane**, head of **Stane International** and a longtime "family friend," starts moving pieces around the board.
- In the workshop under his **Fifth Avenue mansion**, Tony builds the **gold Mark II** and makes his first flight over Long Island Sound.
- The **Maria Stark Foundation** gala: Tony meets **Pepper** on the dance floor, and Stan Lee is mistaken for Hugh Hefner.
- Tony finds out that **Stark weapons are still reaching Wong-Chu**.
- He builds the **red-and-gold Mark III** and flies to Afghanistan to wipe out the arms stockpile. Wong-Chu's forces are shattered.
- The press notices a "flying metal man." Tony's cover story is that it's **his bodyguard**.
- A S.H.I.E.L.D. agent, **Jasper Sitwell**, keeps trying to book a debriefing. Tony keeps not showing up.

## ACT THREE: CHECKMATE

- Pepper gets into Stark Industries' servers and finds that **Stane has been selling weapons to Wong-Chu and ordered the ambush on Tony's convoy**.
- Stane has launched a **hostile takeover** of Stark Industries and has reverse-engineered the Mark I from the wreckage his contacts recovered.
- He ambushes Tony at home and **rips the chest plate out** ("Every king falls, Tony. It's just a matter of moves"), leaving him to die.
- Tony survives by crawling to the **wall socket** and plugging in the old Mark I chest plate that Pepper had framed.
- The finale runs across Long Island: **Iron Monger vs. Iron Man**. Stane is stronger. **Tony wins by out-thinking him**. He lures Iron Monger into the facility's power grid and overloads it.
- Beaten and unmasked, **Stane takes his own life** (off-screen) rather than be arrested.
- The press conference. Pepper hands Tony the **bodyguard story** on note cards. He looks at them, puts them down, and says:

*"The truth is... I am Iron Man."*

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## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>Tuesday, January 8, 2008</b> (the ambush) → <b>Friday, April 25, 2008</b> (the press conference). The post-credit scene takes place <b>Saturday, April 26, 2008</b> . Tony is in captivity for <b>about three months</b> (January–March 2008).                            |
| Where it's set          | <b>Kunar Province, Afghanistan</b> (filmed in Lone Pine, CA) · <b>Stark Industries HQ, Long Island, NY</b> · <b>Tony's mansion, 890 Fifth Avenue, Manhattan</b> (future Avengers Mansion) · <b>Long Island Sound</b> · <b>Washington, D.C.</b> (a Senate hearing Tony skips) |
| Relative to other films | <b>The first chronological event of the modern MCU.</b> It ends a few weeks before <i>The Incredible Hulk</i> (Film #2), and the two overlap: the gamma incident is on the news in Tony's workshop.                                                                          |

### Stark family timeline (canon):

| Event | Date |

|---|---|

| Tony Stark born | May 29, 1981 |

| Howard & Maria Stark die in a car crash | December 16, 2002 (Tony is 21 and takes over Stark Industries) |

| The ambush in Kunar | January 8, 2008 |

| "I am Iron Man" | April 25, 2008 |

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## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **Stark Industries** on Long Island, **Stane International** as its rival, and Tony's **Fifth Avenue mansion** with the workshop underneath.
- **The armor progression** (gray → gold → red and gold), the **chest plate** and its recharging problem, **repulsors** and the **uni-beam**.
- **The supporting cast:** Pepper, Happy, Rhodey, Yinsen's legacy, Stane.
- **The Maria Stark Foundation**, the Stark family's charity.
- **The rules:** Iron Man is **technology, not magic**. Anything the armor does has to be something Tony could build.



## World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                             | How it appears                                                                                                                                                                  | Payoff                                                          |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>S.H.I.E.L.D.</b>              | Agent <b>Jasper Sitwell</b> keeps trying to debrief Tony. The acronym is said once in full: <i>Strategic Hazard Intervention Espionage Logistics Directorate</i> .              | The post-credit scene, and every Phase 1 film                   |
| <b>The Hulk</b>                  | A TV in Tony's workshop plays a news report: "...an accident at the Army's gamma test site at Desert Base, New Mexico... General Thaddeus Ross declined to comment..."          | <b><i>The Incredible Hulk</i></b> (Film #2)                     |
| <b>Hank Pym / Ant-Man</b>        | Tony tosses a science journal onto his workbench. The cover story is <b>Dr. Henry Pym, "Pym Particles: Shrinking the Future."</b> Tony mutters: <i>"Show-off."</i>              | <i>Ant-Man and the Wasp</i>                                     |
| <b>Janet van Dyne / The Wasp</b> | At the Maria Stark Foundation gala, a fashion designer in a black-and-yellow gown teases Tony about his tuxedo. Pepper introduces her as <b>"Janet van Dyne, the designer."</b> | <i>Ant-Man and the Wasp / The Avengers</i>                      |
| <b>The Mandarin</b>              | The mid-credit scene (see Section 7)                                                                                                                                            | <i>Iron Man 2</i>                                               |
| <b>Rhodey in armor</b>           | Rhodey looks at the empty Mark II and says, <i>"Next time, baby."</i>                                                                                                           | <i>Iron Man 2</i> (616: <i>Iron Man</i> #169)                   |
| <b>Avengers Mansion</b>          | Tony's Fifth Avenue home is shown at length: the grand hall, the stairs, the portrait of Howard and Maria                                                                       | <i>The Avengers</i> (Tony hands it over to the team, as in 616) |
| <b>"The Avengers"</b>            | Said for the first time by Nick Fury in the post-credit scene                                                                                                                   | <i>The Avengers</i> (Film #8)                                   |

## Setting up the Big Bad (Thanos / the Infinity Saga)

The setup is deliberately hidden. A general audience won't catch it, but the comic fans will.

| Seed                  | How it appears                                                                                                                                                                                                | What it means                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Mistress Death</b> | When <b>Yinsen dies</b> , only the audience sees <b>a pale woman in a dark hooded cloak</b> at the cave mouth, silent. She looks at Yinsen, then at Tony. Then she's gone. No music sting and no explanation. | <b>Thanos's beloved.</b> She's the reason for the whole saga, she visits the dying, and <b>she has already noticed Tony Stark.</b> |
| <b>Titan</b>          | In the workshop, a Stark satellite feed Tony hacked flags an anomaly: <i>"Unidentified object departing orbit of Titan, Saturn's sixth moon."</i> Tony closes the window: <i>"Not my problem."</i>            | <b>Thanos's home.</b> A Titan-launched ship is on the move.                                                                        |
| <b>Iron Man #55</b>   | Easter egg: the Stark Industries press-conference podium is numbered <b>"55"</b>                                                                                                                              | Thanos's first appearance was in <i>Iron Man</i> #55 (1973), a note for the fans.                                                  |

## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mid-credit scene       | <p>✓ YES: "THE RINGS." A mountain fortress somewhere in China. A battered <b>Wong-Chu</b> kneels and presents a crate holding the <b>wreckage of the Mark I helmet</b>. A hand reaches in. It wears <b>ten rings</b>, each one different, all clearly <b>not of this Earth</b>. A calm voice: <i>"The iron man."</i> <b>CUT TO BLACK.</b> (<i>The Mandarin, voice only, for Iron Man 2.</i>)</p>                                                                                    |
| Post-credit scene      | <p>✓ YES: "THE INITIATIVE." Tony's Fifth Avenue mansion, night. Tony walks in and finds someone standing by the window in the dark: <b>Nick Fury</b>. Eye patch. Long coat. Cigar. <b>FURY:</b> <i>"'I am Iron Man.' You think you're the only superhero in the world, Mr. Stark?"</i> (beat) <i>"You've gotten yourself into something much bigger than your company. I'm here to talk to you about the Avengers Initiative."</i> <b>CUT TO BLACK. "IRON MAN WILL RETURN."</b></p> |
| Secret shoot codenames | <p>Post-credit: "<b>RHODEY'S BIRTHDAY PARTY</b>" (a skeleton crew of 12, sides collected after every take). Mid-credit: "<b>GRANDPA'S JEWELRY BOX.</b>"</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

## 8. ★ FIRST FILM ONLY: HOW IT KICKS EVERYTHING OFF

| Field                                     | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| How the film launches the shared universe | <p><i>Iron Man</i> works entirely as a standalone film, and it quietly <b>builds the foundation for everything after it</b>. It establishes <b>S.H.I.E.L.D.</b> as the thread that runs through every later film. It establishes <b>a public superhero</b> ("I am Iron Man"), which puts heroes in the open for the rest of the saga. It gives the future Avengers a <b>home</b> (890 Fifth Avenue) and a <b>source of money</b> (Stark and the Maria Stark Foundation). And it opens <b>a door to other films</b> through the Desert Base news report and the Pym journal.</p> |
| The first reveal                          | <p><b>The post-credit scene.</b> Most of the audience will have walked out and the ushers will be sweeping popcorn. The people who stay see <b>Nick Fury</b> in Tony's living room say the word "<b>Avengers.</b>" That's the moment the world gets bigger.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| What the fans discover, and when          | <p><b>Opening night (Thursday May 1 at midnight, and Friday May 2):</b> shaky camera-phone video of the post-credit scene is on YouTube within hours. By Saturday, message boards are breaking down every Easter egg: Desert Base, the Pym journal, Titan, podium 55. <b>By Monday, May 5,</b> AICN and SuperHeroHype have threads titled "<b>ARE THE MARVEL MOVIES CONNECTED??</b>" Marvel says nothing.</p>                                                                                                                                                                   |
| The unexplained seed                      | <p><b>The hooded woman at Yinsen's death.</b> Nobody officially notices her for years. Some fans see her and argue about her on forums, and she's dismissed as an extra, a mistake, or Yinsen's wife. <b>She's the saga's quietest and most important seed.</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## Seeds planted for Phase 1

| Seed                                      | Pays off in                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| S.H.I.E.L.D. / Jasper Sitwell             | Every Phase 1 film                                          |
| Desert Base gamma accident, General Ross  | <i>The Incredible Hulk</i> (Film #2, Friday June 13, 2008)  |
| The Pym journal ("Pym Particles")         | <i>Ant-Man and the Wasp</i> (Film #4, Nov 6, 2009)          |
| Janet van Dyne at the gala                | <i>Ant-Man and the Wasp</i> (Film #4) / <i>The Avengers</i> |
| The Mandarin and the ten rings            | <i>Iron Man 2</i> (Film #5, May 7, 2010)                    |
| "Next time, baby" (Rhodey's armor)        | <i>Iron Man 2</i> (Film #5)                                 |
| Fury and "the Avengers Initiative"        | <i>The Avengers</i> (Film #8)                               |
| 890 Fifth Avenue becomes Avengers Mansion | <i>The Avengers</i>                                         |
| The Titan anomaly                         | Phase 1 finale / <i>The Avengers</i> post-credit (Thanos)   |
| The hooded woman (Death)                  | The whole Infinity Saga                                     |

## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted
- [x] Comic Accuracy Report, including powers for every character
- [x] Real title and decoy title
- [x] What the movie is about
- [x] Villain / antagonist
- [x] Post-credit scene(s)
- [x] The film's own world-building
- [x] MCU world-building
- [x] Big Bad setup
- [x] Whose film / franchise it is
- [x] When and where it's set in the MCU timeline
- [x] **First film only:** how it kicks everything off